

Zomato Employee Handbook

Version 4.2 · Effective 1 April 2026 · Owner: People Operations

1. Welcome to Zomato

Zomato connects millions of customers with restaurants and delivery partners every day. We are a technology company at heart, and our work touches food, logistics, payments and support. This handbook explains how we work, what you can expect from us and what we expect from you. If anything here conflicts with your employment contract, the contract applies.

2. Our values

- **Customer obsession.** Start with what the customer, restaurant partner or delivery partner needs, then work backwards.
- **Ownership.** If you see a problem, you own it until it is fixed or handed over clearly.
- **Speed with care.** We move fast, and we do not cut corners on food safety, payments or privacy.
- **Simple and honest.** Say what you mean, share bad news early and prefer plain language over jargon.
- **Respect for everyone.** Every person who works with Zomato, from a rider to a director, deserves courtesy and dignity.

3. Employment basics

New employees serve a **probation period of 6 months**. Confirmation depends on a probation review with your manager in month 5. During probation either side may end employment with 15 days' notice. Employment types are Full-time, Fixed-term and Intern. Benefits in this handbook apply to full-time employees unless stated otherwise. Interns receive a stipend and access to the learning portal but not leave or insurance benefits.

4. Working hours

Standard hours are 10:00 to 19:00, Monday to Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours are 11:00 to 17:00, when you are expected to be available for meetings. Teams that support live operations, such as Customer Support, Delivery Operations and Payments on-call, work in shifts that managers confirm at least seven days in advance.

Overtime is not paid for salaried roles. Work on a public holiday or weekly off for an on-call incident is compensated with a compensatory off within 30 days. Compensatory offs expire after 60 days if unused.

5. Annual leave

Full-time employees receive **24 days of paid annual leave** per calendar year, credited on 1 January. New joiners receive leave pro-rated from their joining date, rounded up to the nearest half day.

- Up to **5 unused days** may be carried over into the next year. Anything above 5 days lapses on 31 March.
- Leave of more than 3 consecutive days needs manager approval at least 14 days ahead. Shorter leave needs approval at least 2 working days ahead, except in emergencies.
- Weekends and public holidays that fall inside a leave period are not counted as leave.
- Annual leave cannot be encashed while you are employed. On exit, unused balance up to 15 days is paid out.
- Apply for leave in the Leave Portal. Your manager approves or declines within 2 working days.

6. Sick leave

You receive **12 days of paid sick leave** per year. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than 2 consecutive days. Sick leave does not carry over and cannot be encashed. If you are unwell on a working day, inform your manager before 10:00 on the same day.

7. Parental leave

Type	Paid leave	Notes
Maternity	26 weeks	Can start up to 8 weeks before the due date. A further 4 weeks of unpaid leave can be requested.
Paternity	4 weeks	Take within 6 months of the birth. Can be split into two blocks.
Adoption	12 weeks	Applies to the primary caregiver, regardless of gender.
Surrogacy	12 weeks	Applies to the intending parent who is the primary caregiver.

On return from parental leave, you can use a phased schedule of 4 hours a day for the first 2 weeks. Zomato offices have a creche partnership; ask People Operations for the list of partner creches near your location.

8. Other leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Rule
Bereavement	5 days	Immediate family. 3 days for extended family.
Marriage	5 days	Once during employment, for your own marriage.
Floating holidays	2 days per year	For local or personal festivals. Apply 7 days ahead.
Study leave	Up to 10 days	For exams linked to an approved course, with manager approval.
Sabbatical	Up to 3 months unpaid	After 4 years of service, subject to business needs.
Voting day	1 day	Paid, on presenting proof of voting.

9. Hybrid work

Most corporate teams follow a hybrid model: **3 days in the office** (Tuesday to Thursday) and 2 days remote. Managers may adjust this for team needs and will tell you in writing. Customer Support and Delivery Operations roles are office or shift based and are not covered by the hybrid model.

- Working from another city for more than 10 working days in a quarter needs written approval from HR.
- Working from another country is not permitted without Legal and Finance approval, because of tax and visa rules.
- Remote days still follow core hours, and you should be reachable on Slack.
- A one-time **work-from-home setup allowance of ₹15,000** is available for a desk and chair, claimable through the Expense Portal.

10. Compensation

Salary is paid on the last working day of each month into your registered bank account. Your compensation has a fixed part and, for some roles, a variable part paid with the April salary. Salary increments are reviewed once a year, effective 1 May, based on your performance rating and market data.

Employee stock options (ESOPs)

Eligible employees receive ESOPs that **vest over 4 years with a 1-year cliff**: 25% vests after your first anniversary, then the rest vests monthly over the following 3 years. Vested options can be exercised during the exercise windows announced by Finance. Leaving the company starts a 90-day exercise period for vested options.

Taxes and payslips

Taxes are deducted at source. Payslips and Form 16 are available in the Payroll Portal. Submit investment declarations by 31 January each year.

11. Benefits

- **Health insurance:** cover of ₹5 lakh for you, your spouse and up to two children, paid fully by the company. Parents can be added at a discounted group premium paid by you.
- **Accident and life cover:** accidental death cover of ₹50 lakh and term life cover of 3 times your annual fixed pay.
- **Meal credits:** ₹3,000 per month in Zomato credits, usable on the app. Unused credits expire at month end.
- **Learning budget:** ₹40,000 per year for courses, books and conferences, with manager approval. Unspent budget does not carry over.
- **Wellness:** 6 free counselling sessions per year through the employee assistance programme, plus a monthly gym or fitness reimbursement of up to ₹1,500.
- **Phone and internet:** reimbursement of up to ₹1,000 per month for work-related use.
- **Relocation:** for approved transfers, a relocation package covering travel, temporary housing for 30 days and shipping of household goods up to ₹75,000.
- **Referral bonus:** ₹50,000 if someone you refer joins and completes 6 months. ₹75,000 for referrals into engineering roles marked as priority.

12. Performance and promotions

Reviews happen twice a year, in April and October. Each review combines a self-assessment, manager feedback and two peer reviews. Ratings use a five-point scale from Needs Improvement to Outstanding, and they influence the annual increment and promotion cycle.

Promotions are decided by a calibration committee that looks for sustained work at the next level for at least two review cycles. Employees on a Needs Improvement rating are placed on a 90-day improvement plan with clear goals and weekly check-ins.

13. Code of conduct

We treat colleagues, restaurant partners, delivery partners and customers with respect. Harassment, discrimination and retaliation are not tolerated anywhere, including online, at offsites and at company events.

Prevention of sexual harassment (POSH)

Zomato has an Internal Committee under the POSH Act. Complaints can be made in writing to the committee, and every complaint is handled confidentially. The committee starts an inquiry within 10 working days and aims to complete it within 90 days. Retaliation against a complainant is a serious violation.

Raising concerns

Concerns can be raised with your manager, with People Operations, or anonymously through the Ethics Helpline at ethics@zomato.example. Every report is reviewed within 5 working days, and you will be told the outcome where the law allows.

14. Conflicts of interest and gifts

You must disclose any outside business interest, a role on another company's board, or a relationship with a vendor or restaurant partner that could influence your decisions. Do not accept gifts worth more than **₹2,000** from a vendor, partner or customer; report any gift above that limit to your manager and return it politely. Cash gifts are never acceptable. Outside work for another company needs written approval.

15. Information security and data privacy

- Lock your laptop when you step away from it.
- Never share customer, restaurant or rider data over personal email, personal cloud storage or chat apps.
- Use the company VPN on any network that is not the office network.
- Use the company password manager and do not reuse passwords. Two-factor authentication is mandatory for email, GitHub and the Admin dashboard.
- Report lost or stolen devices to IT within 2 hours, and report suspected phishing to security@zomato.example.
- Access to production data is granted on a need-to-know basis and is logged and reviewed every quarter.

Customer data may only be used for the purpose it was collected. Data requests from customers, such as deletion or access requests, are handled by the Privacy team within 30 days.

16. Company devices and social media

Company laptops are for work use. Do not install unlicensed software. You may use personal social media, but do not share confidential information, and make clear that your views are your own. Only the Communications team speaks for Zomato to the press.

17. Grievance redressal

If you have a problem with your manager, team or working conditions, first try to resolve it with the person involved. If that does not work, escalate to your skip-level manager, then to People Operations. A formal grievance can be filed in the Grievance Portal; it is acknowledged within 2 working days and resolved within 15 working days.

18. Notice period and exit

The standard notice period is **60 days** for most roles and **90 days** for managers and above. Notice can be shortened by mutual agreement, or bought out by paying the salary for the remaining days. Unused annual leave cannot be used to offset notice without manager approval.

- On your last day, return your laptop, access card and any other company property.
- Your accounts are disabled at the end of your last working day.
- An exit interview is held in your final week, and your feedback is anonymised.
- Full and final settlement, including unused leave payout, is processed within 45 days of the last working day.
- The experience letter and relieving letter are issued after the settlement is cleared.

19. Contacts

Topic	Contact
Leave and payroll	peopleops@zomato.example
IT support	itdesk@zomato.example
Security incidents	security@zomato.example
Ethics Helpline	ethics@zomato.example
Expense queries	finance-help@zomato.example